

02/06/2025

Inflict, Shall, Mutilate, Pondering, Admiration

1. Inflict (थोपना, पहुँचाना) (Verb) (in-FLIKT) (Serious/Neutral Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** To cause something unpleasant or harmful to be suffered by someone or something.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी पर कुछ हानिकारक या अप्रिय थोपना या पहुँचाना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *infectus* (past participle of *infigere*) → *in-* ("on") + *figere* ("to strike") → Old French *infecter* → **English inflict**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Impose, Deliver, Administer
 - **Antonym:** Relieve, Withdraw, Spare
- **Connotation:** Mostly **negative**, used in serious contexts (violence, damage, trauma).
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A soldier unknowingly inflicts pain on civilians during a crossfire.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In conflict zones, it is often civilians who suffer the most. Armed forces, in pursuit of military objectives, sometimes inflict unintended damage on infrastructure and

livelihoods. Reports from war-torn regions show the psychological scars inflicted on children are often long-term and deeply embedded. Policies addressing such crises must ensure that harm is not repeatedly inflicted under the guise of justice or retaliation. Similarly, in domestic contexts, emotional abuse inflicts wounds that are invisible yet damaging. To create a better society, we must reduce circumstances that inflict any kind of pain—emotional or physical—on the vulnerable.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  **Correct:** The enemy forces inflicted heavy casualties on the village. (दुश्मन की सेना ने गांव पर भारी हानि पहुँचाई।)
-  **Incorrect:** The teacher inflicted a holiday for the students. (अशुद्ध - "inflicted" का प्रयोग नुकसान या पीड़ा के लिए होता है।)

- **Example + Explanation:**

- The storm inflicted severe damage on the coastal town. (तूफान ने तटीय शहर में गंभीर क्षति पहुँचाई।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - *Subject:* The storm
 - *Verb (V2):* inflicted
 - *Object:* severe damage
 - *Prepositional phrase:* on the coastal town

- **Common Collocations:**

- Inflict pain, Inflict injury, Inflict punishment, Inflict suffering

- **My Statement:**

- The stress inflicted on bank customers when the bank ran out of money. ***
- The stress inflicted on bank customers when the bank ran out of money was overwhelming.
- The thief inflicted mental pain on home owner by stealing valuable items. ***
- The thief inflicted mental pain on the homeowner by stealing valuable items.
- The inflict punishment was harder to resist day by day. ***
- The punishment inflicted was harder to resist day by day.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

2. Shall (करूँगा/करेंगे) (*Modal Verb*) (*shaal*) (*Formal/Neutral Tone*)

- **Meaning (English):** Used to express the future, intention, or duty, often with a sense of formality or determination.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** भविष्य का संकेत या कर्तव्य को दर्शाना; "करूँगा/करेंगे"।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English *scea/* ("I owe, must, shall") → **Proto-Germanic *skalaz*** ("ought to") → Modern English *shall*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Will (in some cases), Must (in legal contexts)
 - **Antonym:** May, Might (less certainty)
- **Connotation:** **Neutral/Formal**, often used in legal, formal, or contractual language.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A contract reads, "The client shall pay the amount within 30 days."



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In legal and contractual language, "shall" is commonly used to signify obligation. For example, "The tenant shall not sublet the property without written consent" is a definitive statement of duty. In formal documents, it removes ambiguity and asserts non-negotiable requirements. However, in modern speech, "will" has largely replaced "shall" in casual future tense usage. That said, "shall" still appears in proposals and declarations, like

"Shall we begin?" or "I shall return." Writers must understand when to use "shall" for intent versus when it's a legal imposition of duty. Context determines both tone and necessity.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  **Correct:** I shall complete the report by tomorrow. (मैं कल तक रिपोर्ट पूरा करूँगा।)
-  **Incorrect:** I shall going to the market. (गलत - Shall के साथ base form (V1) आता है, न कि "going")

- **Example + Explanation:**

- Shall we go for a walk? (क्या हम टहलने चलें?)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - *Modal Verb:* Shall
 - *Subject:* we
 - *Base Verb:* go
 - *Purpose Clause:* for a walk

- **Common Collocations:**

- Shall we...?, You shall not pass, The parties shall agree, It shall be done

- **My Statement:**

- Shall I join you. ***
- Shall I join you?
- The time shall pass like a breeze, you just have to be prepared for the next step.
- She shall return the book in the library before 3 months. ***
- She shall return the book to the library within three months.

- **My Notes:**

- **Bonus Tip on “Shall” vs “Will”:**
 - “Shall” is formal and more common in British English or legal contexts.
 - “Will” is more commonly used in modern spoken English.

3. Mutilate (विकृत करना, अंग-भंग करना) (Verb) (MYOO-ti-late) (Strong Negative Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** To injure, disfigure, or make imperfect by removing or damaging parts.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** अंग-भंग कर देना या किसी चीज़ को विकृत कर देना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *mutilatus*, past participle of *mutilare* ("to cut off") → **Old French** *mutiler* → English *mutilate*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Disfigure, Disable, Deface
 - **Antonym:** Repair, Restore, Heal
- **Connotation:** **Highly negative**, associated with violence or severe harm.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A statue with broken limbs left mutilated by vandals.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Acts of vandalism often mutilate symbols of heritage, stripping them of their original form and meaning. In war zones, both humans and monuments suffer mutilation—either from violence or symbolic defiance. Media reports often use the word to describe physical injuries during assaults, especially when limbs are lost or severely damaged.

Figuratively, one can say that censorship mutilates creative expression by cutting off its original intent. Thus, the term goes beyond physical harm and often includes emotional or artistic disfigurement.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  **Correct:** The manuscript was mutilated by careless editing. (पांडुलिपि को लापरवाह संपादन से विकृत कर दिया गया।)
-  **Incorrect:** He mutilate a beautiful poem. (Subject-verb agreement गलत है; "mutilate" → "mutilated")

- **Example + Explanation:**

- The bomb blast mutilated several buildings in the vicinity. (बम विस्फोट ने आसपास की कई इमारतों को विकृत कर दिया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - *Subject:* The bomb blast
 - *Verb (V2):* mutilated
 - *Object:* several buildings
 - *Prepositional Phrase:* in the vicinity

- **Common Collocations:**

- Mutilated body, Mutilated text, Mutilated sculpture, Mutilated legacy

- **My Statement:**

- The alibi was mutilated before presenting it. ***
- The alibi was so heavily altered and tampered with that it appeared mutilated before being presented in court.
- The state was mutilated in front of the public. ***
- The state's infrastructure was mutilated by years of negligence and violent protests, leaving visible scars across its cities.
- The structure was mutilated by the high-magnitude earthquake.

- **My Notes:**

- "Mutilated" is typically used for physical damage. "Distorted" fits better for abstract concepts like an alibi.

4. Pondering (चिंतन करना) (Verb/Present Participle) (PON-der-ing) (Reflective Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** To think deeply about something; to reflect carefully before deciding.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी विषय पर गहराई से विचार करना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *ponderare* ("to weigh, consider") → **Middle English** *ponderen* → English *ponder* → **pondering (continuous form)**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Contemplating, Reflecting, Musing
 - **Antonym:** Ignoring, Rushing, Neglecting
- **Connotation: Positive/Neutral**, intellectual or introspective undertone.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A student staring out of a window, pondering the future after graduation.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Pondering plays a vital role in the decision-making process, especially when long-term consequences are involved. Philosophers, scientists, and even entrepreneurs rely on deep thought to evaluate variables and outcomes. Pondering is not just mental

idleness—it's an active engagement with uncertainty. In fact, mindfulness practices often begin by asking individuals to ponder their values or choices. From career transitions to ethical dilemmas, the act of pondering offers a pause, a reflective space where ideas ferment into direction. Without this pause, decisions can be rash, ill-informed, or reactive.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  **Correct:** She was quietly pondering the best course of action. (वह चुपचाप सबसे सही रास्ते पर विचार कर रही थी।)
-  **Incorrect:** He pondering about the exam. (गलत - "He is/was pondering" होना चाहिए)

- **Example + Explanation:**

- I've been pondering whether to accept the job offer abroad. (मैं यह सोच रहा हूँ कि विदेश में नौकरी का प्रस्ताव स्वीकार करूँ या नहीं।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - *Subject:* I
 - *Auxiliary:* have been
 - *Verb (V-ing):* pondering
 - *Object/Clause:* whether to accept the job offer abroad

- **Common Collocations:**

- Pondering deeply, Pondering possibilities, Pondering life, Pondering the decision

- **My Statement:**

- We were pondering whether to join a startup or a big corporation. ***
- We were pondering whether to join a startup or a big corporation.
- We should ponder about our future daily and bridge the mismatch of current executions. ***
- We should ponder our future daily and bridge the mismatch in our current actions.
- The child sitting in the park was pondering deeply, can't say what he might be thinking at this moment. ***
- The child sitting in the park was pondering deeply — it's hard to say what he might be thinking at that moment.

5. Admiration (प्रशंसा) (Noun) (ad-muh-RAY-shun) (Positive Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** A feeling of respect and warm approval for someone or something.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी के लिए आदर या प्रशंसा की भावना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *admirari* ("to wonder at") → **Latin *admiratio*** → Old French *admiracion* → English *admiration*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Appreciation, Praise, Esteem
 - **Antonym:** Contempt, Criticism, Disdain
- **Connotation: Positive**, associated with respect and praise.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A crowd applauding a young athlete after a record-breaking performance.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Admiration drives human connection and inspiration. In biographies, leaders and thinkers often describe how someone's work sparked their journey. The admiration of a parent, mentor, or historical figure can lead to a lifelong pursuit of excellence. Admiration is more than praise—it's the acknowledgment of effort, values, or achievements. It can be silent (like a child watching a parent) or vocal (like public recognition). In sociological

studies, admiration is considered a building block of hero culture and social learning. It builds character, reinforces values, and encourages emulation.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  **Correct:** Her dedication earned universal admiration. (उसकी निष्ठा ने उसे सार्वभौमिक प्रशंसा दिलाई।)
-  **Incorrect:** He gave me admiration. (गलत - "admiration" is received, not "given" directly. Better: "I received his admiration.")

- **Example + Explanation:**

- The artist's attention to detail sparked admiration among critics. (कलाकार की बारीकी ने आलोचकों के बीच प्रशंसा अर्जित की।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - *Subject:* The artist's attention to detail
 - *Verb:* sparked
 - *Object:* admiration
 - *Prepositional phrase:* among critics

- **Common Collocations:**

- Earn admiration, Admiration for, Express admiration, Deep admiration

- **My Statement:**

- The teacher earned admiration from her students when they were in cusp to finish their school. ***
- The teacher earned admiration from her students when they were on the cusp of finishing school.
- Admiration is like a trophy for our efforts.
- Everyone deserves a deep admiration in their life no matter how small or big their achievement is. ***
- Everyone deserves deep admiration in their life, no matter how small or big their achievement may be.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]